



All CREATURES great ...

More than 1.3 MILLION SPECIES of animals have been described and named—and there are even more waiting to be discovered. Here are a few of the groups of animals that have a backbone (vertebrates) and, on the next page, those that don't (invertebrates).

MAMMALS

Number of species: 5,513

KEY FEATURES



Give birth to live young



Feed young on milk



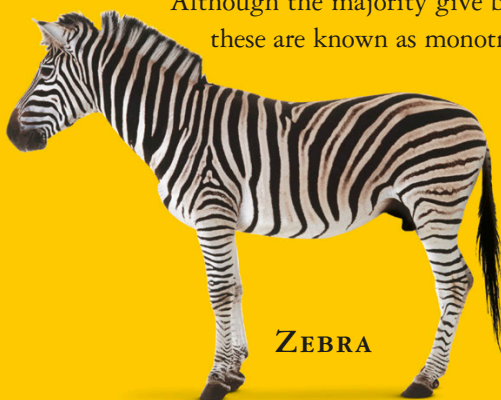
Have hair or fur



Warm-blooded

Mammals were the last group of animals to evolve. They are an extremely diverse group that live on land and in the sea.

Although the majority give birth to well-developed young, two families lay eggs—the platypus and the echidnas; these are known as monotremes. Marsupials, such as kangaroos and koalas, produce undeveloped young, which live in their mother's pouch until they can fend for themselves. Mammals eat meat (carnivores), plants (herbivores), or a mixed diet (omnivores).



ZEBRA

KANGAROO



DOG

RABBIT



HUMAN



BIRDS

Number of species: 10,425

KEY FEATURES



Lay eggs



Covered in feathers

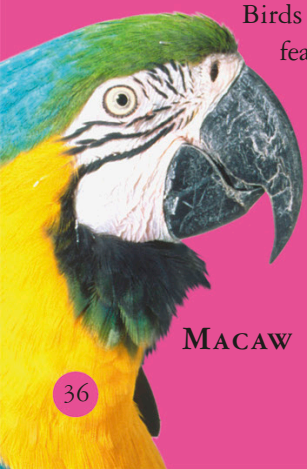


Most fly



Warm-blooded

Birds evolved during the time of the dinosaurs, to which they are closely related. Their feathers are warm and waterproof and they have scaly, clawed feet. Instead of teeth they have a hard bill that is specialized for the type of food that they eat. All birds have wings, but not all can fly. A lightweight skeleton makes flying easier. In some birds, such as the penguin, the wings have been adapted for swimming, while most non-flying land birds use their wings for balance or display.



MACAW

SCARLET IBIS

ROBIN



SWAN



PENGUIN



OSTRICH